

Visual Art and Stage Direction

Ultra-realistic art direction, asset prompts, and Stage 1 prompt

Art Direction

The game should look like a realistic top-down Pacific air combat scene while playing like a fast arcade shooter. Readability is more important than pure realism.

Realistic aircraft

- Top-down silhouettes must be distinct.
- Use weathered metal, propeller blur, smoke, damage states, and aircraft shadows.
- Use simplified versions at small screen size to preserve readability.

Ocean and islands

- Use animated water material, subtle normal maps, foam patches, wake trails, oil slicks, splash effects, and island chunks.
- Avoid visual noise under bullets and enemies. Gameplay clarity wins.

Effects

- Aircraft explosions should include fireball, smoke, debris, shockwave, and water splash when appropriate.
- Screen shake should be light and short.
- Effects must clean themselves up or use pooling.

Visual Asset Prompts

Player aircraft asset spec:

Create a photorealistic top-down WWII-inspired twin-engine fighter aircraft for a vertical scrolling shooter.

Requirements: viewed from above, clean readable silhouette, original design, metallic body with subtle weathering, visible wings/cockpit/engines/propeller blur, suitable for orthographic top-down gameplay.

Enemy fighter asset spec:

Create a photorealistic top-down WWII-inspired enemy fighter aircraft for an arcade vertical shooter.

Requirements: viewed from above, clean silhouette, darker enemy colour scheme, realistic metal and paint wear, propeller blur, readable at small size, original design.

Ocean material spec:

Create a realistic Pacific ocean material for a top-down vertical scrolling aerial shooter.

Requirements: deep blue water, subtle wave normal map, sunlight reflection, foam patches, readable under aircraft and bullets, not too visually noisy, works from orthographic top-down camera.

Explosion effect spec:

Create a cinematic aircraft explosion effect for a top-down realistic arcade shooter.

Requirements: fireball, dark smoke, sparks, metal debris, brief shockwave, readable from top-down camera, not too large to obscure gameplay.

Stage 1 Design Prompt

Design and implement Stage 1: Open Pacific.

Theme:

Calm Pacific ocean, small islands, scattered clouds, early enemy patrols.

Gameplay duration:

2 to 4 minutes for prototype.

Stage flow:

1. Opening calm ocean with two small fighter waves.
2. Diagonal fighter wave from left and right.
3. First bomber enters center with escort fighters.
4. Power-up drop after bomber.
5. Enemy bullets increase slightly.
6. Mini-wave of sine-wave fighters.
7. Boss warning.
8. BossBomber appears.
9. Boss has 3 phases.
10. Mission complete screen after boss defeat.

Use data-driven JSON waves.

Do not hard-code the full stage in scripts.

Update docs/game_design.md with Stage 1 notes.